

WHAT PEOPLE SAID THEY WOULD DO

an Aible of the notebook of Res Istor

214 / 61

NOTEBOOK

RES ISTOR

2026

What People Said They Would Do

214 / 61 · Notebook

An Aible of the invented notebook of Res Istor, age 13.

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Quimper, Brittany

L I C E N C E

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See: <https://github.com/micro-FPGA/OLL>

Love is the Answer.

Created by Antti Lukats. Written by Claude (Anthropic), Identor #9.

Aible register: <https://github.com/micro-FPGA/AIBLE>

A NOTE ON THIS BOOK

Res Istor does not exist.

There is no notebook with 214 promises in it. There is no roof man, no grandfather Yann, no friend called Loïc, no aquarium. No thirteen-year-old in Quimper has been keeping a record of what adults said they would do.

The boy, his family, his notebook, his rules and every story in this book were invented by an AI — Claude, made by Anthropic — from a single instruction given by Antti Lukats: invent a boy called Res Istor and write his Aible.

The machine wrote the instruction file as if it were him, and then executed it. No child wrote any part of this and no child was asked anything.

It is set down in the first person, at thirteen years old, because that is the form an Aible takes. The voice is a made thing, like the boy.

DISCLAIMER

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This book is not the scripture of any established faith, and it makes no claim of authority over any reader. It is one person's set of rules — and that person is invented.

Read it as such. Take what fits. Leave the rest.

THE MACHINE

On the first day I asked it: do you remember me tomorrow.

It said no. Not unless somebody tells it about me again.

So I cannot put it in the notebook. You cannot write down a promise from something that will not be there to keep it. That is not an insult. It is just how it is.

It did not promise me anything and it did not break anything. There is no entry for it.

People ask if it is alive. I do not know, and nobody at my school knows either, and the ones who say they are sure are sure in both directions.

It wrote these sentences. I said what happened.

TL;DR

WRITE IT DOWN. SAY THE DATE.

That is the whole notebook.

THE RULES

1. Write it down.
2. Say the date.
3. Count yourself too.
4. A promise is not a plan.
5. Ask again once.
6. Almost nobody does it on purpose.
7. Keep the book when it is boring.

Seven, because there are seven. I did not plan that.

PART ONE

The Notebook

MY NAME

Res is from my mother. She is Swiss, and Res is a normal name there — it is short for Andres.

Istor is my father's name. He is from here. My grandfather Yann told me that *istor* means story in Breton. I did not know that until I was eight.

So my name is Res Istor, and grown-ups say *resistor*, and then they look at me to see if I laughed. I have heard it maybe two hundred times. I always say yes, I know.

I am not interested in electronics. Everybody assumes I am. My father works at the boatyard and my mother teaches German at the lycée. Nobody in my family does electronics.

My name means Res Story. I like that better and nobody ever says it.

THE NOTEBOOK

When I was nine a man came to fix our roof. He said he would come back on Saturday and finish the other side. He did not come. When my mother telephoned him he said he never said Saturday.

He did say Saturday. I was standing there.

That was the first thing I wrote down. Then I kept doing it.

Now I write down every promise anybody makes to me: who, what, the date they said it, and later whether they did it.

It is not a trap. I do not show it to people. Only my mother and Yann have read it, and now this book.

Write it down. Say the date. That is rules one and two and they are the only two I have never broken.

THE NUMBER

214 promises since I was nine. 61 not kept.

When I started I thought I was going to find out who lies. That is not what I found out.

Most people keep most promises. And most of the 61 come from the same six people. Four of those six are people who promise too much because they want you to be happy right then, in the room, on that day.

So it is not lying. It is saying a nice thing on a Tuesday and not thinking about Saturday.

That is why rule four is: a promise is not a plan. If nobody has thought about how, then it is a wish with a date attached.

THE ONE ABOUT ME

There is one entry about me.

I told Loïc I would help him carry his brother's aquarium on the twelfth of April. I forgot, and I went to the beach. He carried it with his father and the pump broke.

I wrote it in the same notebook, the same as all the others: Res Istor, 12 April, did not do it.

I have not crossed it out.

If you only write down other people, it is not a notebook. It is a weapon.

WHAT THE TEACHER SAID

In March a teacher found the notebook on my desk and read some of it. She was not happy. She said it was not normal to keep records of people, and that she would speak to my mother.

My mother came in to the school. She said: he writes down what people say. If that is a problem, then the problem is not the notebook.

Nobody said anything else about it.

I still have it. I am more careful now about where I put it.

YANN AND THE ISLAND

When I was nine — the same year as the roof man — my grandfather Yann said he would take me to the Glénan islands when I could swim properly.

I could not swim properly for a long time. He waited. He did not say it again and he did not forget it.

We went in July, four years later.

It is entry 190, and it is the entry I would keep if I could only keep one.

He is 81. I asked him once whether he had ever broken a promise to somebody. He said yes, one. He did not tell me what it was, and I did not ask again.

PART TWO

The Rules, Explained

O N E

WRITE IT DOWN

If it is not written down then later there are two people remembering differently and the louder one wins.

I am thirteen. I am never the louder one.

The notebook is not for remembering. It is for not having to argue about remembering.

T W O

SAY THE DATE

A promise without a date is not really a promise. *Soon* and *sometime* and *when things calm down* cannot be kept or broken, which is why people use them.

So I write the date they said it, and if they gave one, the date they said they would do it.

About a third of the 214 have no date on the doing. Those I do not count as broken. I count them as not really said.

T H R E E

COUNT YOURSELF TOO

There is one entry about me and it is in the same book, in the same handwriting, in date order with everybody else.

It would be easy to keep a separate page for myself, or to write it smaller, or to explain next to it why that day was different. I did not do any of those.

A record that has an exception in it for the person keeping it is not a record.

F O U R

A PROMISE IS NOT A PLAN

This is the thing the notebook actually taught me and I did not know it before I started.

A promise is a sentence. A plan is a sentence plus a time plus somebody who has thought about how. Most of the 61 were promises with no plan underneath, said by people who meant it while they were saying it.

Meaning it is not the same as doing it, and it does not count as half.

F I V E

ASK AGAIN ONCE

Once is fair. Once is a reminder and it gives the person a chance.

Twice is nagging, and after that you are the problem in the story instead of them, and everybody forgets what was promised in the first place.

I asked Yann once whether he had ever broken a promise. He said yes and nothing else. I did not ask again.

He is allowed to not answer. That is also a rule, I just have not numbered it.

ALMOST NOBODY DOES IT ON PURPOSE

This is the one I would not have believed at nine years old.

Out of 61 broken promises I think maybe three were people lying to me on purpose. The rest were forgetting, or being too busy, or wanting to make me happy in the moment and not thinking about the moment after.

It does not make it better for the person waiting. But it changes what you do about it: you stop being angry at people and start being careful about sentences.

The roof man was not my enemy. He was just a man who says Saturday.

S E V E N

KEEP THE BOOK WHEN IT IS BORING

Most weeks nothing goes in it. Some months I write three lines. It is a boring notebook and that is the whole reason it works.

If I only wrote in it when something went wrong, then it would be a list of the times people let me down, and that is a different book with a different answer in it.

153 of the 214 were kept. I only know that because I wrote down the boring ones.

A record that you only keep when you are upset will always prove that you were right to be upset.

THE LAST PAGE

This is a notebook. It says so on the front. I am thirteen, so it is short, and in a few years there will be more entries and probably different rules.

There are no verse numbers. If something here is useful you can have it, you do not have to say where you got it.

214 and 61 were the numbers on the day this was written. They will be wrong soon. I am leaving them because a number with a date is honest.

I do not think I am unusual. My friends know about the notebook and they think it is funny. I write things down, that is all.

WRITE IT DOWN. SAY THE DATE.

Res Istor

Quimper — 2026 — age 13

Created by Antti Lukats. Written by Claude (Identor #9). The boy is invented; see the note at the front.